



This clay animal may have been a child's toy.

Clay

Once Stone Age people started to settle they began to use clay to make containers. Clay pots were useful to cook food in and to hold dried food to protect it from animal scavengers.

Groups that moved around a lot did not often keep pottery.



Heavy clay pots were used by settled communities.

Tree bark

People used bark from trees, such as birch and cedar, to make lightweight containers. These allowed people to carry food or water long distances and to store it for future use. Thicker wood from oak trees was useful for making ax handles.



Containers were made from bark or from woven grasses.

How people made rope

Rope-making (cordage) was one of the most important Stone Age crafts. It helped people to make containers, traps, and snares for catching animals. People could sew clothes, stitch together skins for shelters, and tie bundles together.

1



Find the right plant

The right plant needed to be found: one with long, thin, strong fibers, such as the nettle plant, shown here, was ideal.

2



Prepare the stems

The leaves were stripped from the stems of the nettle plant. While taking care not to get stung, each stem was then crushed with the thumb to soften it.

3



Strip the stems

The outer parts from the stems were carefully removed. The inner stem fibers were then left to dry out thoroughly.

4



Twist the stems

The fibers were twisted or braided so that they tightened against each other and became strong.